Golf Edge: Audience, Product, and Launch Plan

1. What we're building

Golf Edge turns professional golf into a weekly rivalry among friends.

Players make picks, follow their group's competition, challenge the model, and return for a rematch.

The stats and predictions help people make decisions. The friendships and competition give them a reason to return.

2. Who we target first

Our first audience is **golf fans who enjoy fantasy sports and can bring a few friends into a group.**

The most valuable early user is the organizer: the person who already runs a fantasy league, golf trip, group chat, or weekly game.

Audience	Their reason to try Golf Edge	Our approach
Golf fan and group	A new competition for their friends	Recruit personally and help
Golf fan joining a	Make picks and compete	Make joining and picking quick
Sports fan who doesn't follow golf	Beat their friends without needing expert knowledge	Offer simple guidance and an assisted first lineup
Dedicated golf	Explore predictions and find an	Keep deeper analysis available

We will welcome beginners without requiring them to be our main source of early growth.

3. The experience we must get right

The essential journey is:

Receive an invite → join the right group → make picks → understand the matchup → see the result → play again.

Every development decision should improve one of these steps.

Before the tournament

A new player should immediately understand:

- Who invited them and which group they are joining.
- What they need to pick.
- When picks lock.
- How the winner is determined.
- Whether their picks have been saved.

Choose one recommended starting game for the pilot. Let It Ride is a reasonable candidate because the basic action is picking three golfers. Explain its season usage limits where players make their choices.

Keep the other games available, but avoid asking a beginner to understand every format before playing.

During the tournament

The Match Center should answer:

- Am I winning?
- Who am I chasing?
- Which golfers are helping or hurting me?
- Are these live estimates or final results?

Show the answer first, with scoring details available underneath.

After the tournament

The recap should show:

- Who won and by how much.
- The biggest contribution or turning point supported by the data.
- How the group performed against the model.
- The next event and a clear way to play again.

Use wording that fits the group size. Clearly identify lineup earnings so they are not mistaken for cash prizes.

4. Build priorities

First: Remove friction from the core mobile experience

Prioritize these screens:

1. Invitation and sign-in.
2. Group home.
3. Pick selection and confirmation.
4. Match Center.
5. Recap and next-event entry.

Check them on actual phones. Fix cramped controls, excessive scrolling, unclear labels, and missing confirmation before investing in a separate mobile app.

Completion test: A first-time player can join and submit valid picks without you explaining the interface.

Second: Help beginners make their first decision

Add or refine an optional **"Help me pick"** path:

- Suggest an editable lineup.
- Explain each suggestion in one plain-language sentence.
- Respect eligibility and remaining golfer uses.
- Make clear that suggestions are not guaranteed outcomes.

Observe your non-golf friend using this path. Determine whether the obstacle is choosing golfers, understanding scoring, navigating the site, or simply having little interest in golf.

Completion test: A beginner can make picks and explain what needs to happen for their lineup to win.

Third: Make the organizer's job easy

An organizer needs to:

- Create a group with sensible defaults.
- Send an invitation that opens the correct group.

- See who has joined and who still needs to pick, without revealing hidden picks.
- Share the result and start the next week.

Initially, you can help organizers personally. Build automation around repeated problems you actually observe.

Completion test: An organizer can run a second tournament without your assistance.

Fourth: Strengthen reasons to return

Use the features already built:

- Group standings.
- Competition against the model.
- Clear weekly results.
- Sunday recap.
- Next-event prompt.

Add reminders only with appropriate user controls. Make them timely and useful.

Completion test: Players return for another event without a personal message from you.

5. Run a three-tournament pilot

Recruit **five organizers**, each bringing roughly **three to six friends**. These are recruiting targets, not requirements to delay starting.

Include mostly golf fans, with a few non-golf sports fans joining through friends.

Tournament one: Observe first use

Watch several people join and make picks without coaching them immediately.

Record:

- Where they hesitate.
- What they misunderstand.
- Where they abandon the process.
- Whether they know their picks are saved.

Fix the most common barriers.

Tournament two: Observe engagement

Find out whether players open the Match Center and understand it.

Ask:

- “What brought you back?”
- “Was there a moment you cared about your position?”
- “Did anyone talk about the game outside the app?”

Fix anything that prevents people from following their competition.

Tournament three: Observe repeat play

Reduce your personal prompting and see which groups continue.

Ask:

- “Would your group play the next event?”
- “What would you miss if Golf Edge disappeared?”
- “What made this feel like work?”
- “Who would you invite?”

Look for behavior as well as positive feedback.

6. Measure what matters

Track only enough information to understand the experience. Start with a simple weekly scorecard.

Measure	What it tells us
Invited players who submit their first picks	Whether joining and starting are working
First-week players who submit picks again	Whether people want another week
Groups with multiple active players across all three events	Whether group competition is taking hold
Players who check the Match Center during	Whether the competition creates interest
Invitations sent without your prompting	Whether users want to bring others

Support needed per group	Whether the experience can grow beyond your personal help

Track golf fans and non-golf fans separately where practical, using an optional self-description.

Our primary signal is repeat group participation. Sign-ups alone do not demonstrate that the game is working.

7. How we recruit

Start with people and communities you can reach directly:

- Existing fantasy league organizers.
- Golf buddies and golf-trip organizers.
- Local golf groups where you have relationships.
- Friends who follow professional golf and enjoy competition.

Use a specific invitation:

“I’m testing a weekly golf game for friend groups. Would you bring a few friends and play three tournaments? I’d like honest feedback on whether it’s something you’d keep playing.”

Lead with the competition. Show the analytics once someone wants help picking.

Wait to spend meaningfully on advertising until groups are returning and the invitation process works reliably.

8. What we deliberately postpone

Until the pilot identifies a clear need, postpone:

- Additional game formats.
- A full native mobile app.
- Broad paid marketing.
- More complex prediction displays.
- A major redesign.
- Complicated subscriptions or monetization.

Continue necessary work on reliability, account privacy, scoring accuracy, and data permissions.

Keep licensing conversations moving alongside the pilot. Confirm that the agreed data rights cover the actual uses we intend, including public display, game scoring, derived outputs, and any future commercial use.

9. How we decide what comes next

After three tournaments:

Observed result	Next move
Groups return and invite others	Recruit another small set of organizers
Players struggle to submit picks	Simplify onboarding and selection
Picks are easy, but players don't	Investigate whether the competition is compelling
Golf fans return; non-golf friends	Focus acquisition more tightly on golf fans
Beginners return when friends	Improve the invited-player experience
Phone friction repeatedly blocks active users	Prioritize mobile improvements; evaluate an app against those specific problems
Organizers need constant help	Improve group management before expanding

A useful initial milestone is **three of the five pilot groups continuing through all three tournaments, with multiple active players in each**. This is a working threshold for deciding whether to expand the test, not proof of a sustainable business.

10. Our development rule

Before adding a feature, ask:

Will this help someone join, make picks, follow their friends, or return next week?

If the answer is unclear, put it in the backlog and learn from the next tournament.